

Intel's Ivy Bridge

Intel has launched fourteen new 3rd Generation Core processors (Ivy Bridge), based on 22nm 3-D tri-gate fabrication technology.



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Intel Core i7-3770K

Finally an offering with integrated graphics worth talking about

Intel Sandy Bridge processors have been the favourite of mainstream system builders, but their integrated graphics namely HD3000 and HD2000 did not offer much in terms of gaming. With the first Intel Ivy Bridge processor, namely Core i7-3770K, we see an improvement on the gaming front.

The Core i7-3770K is based on a 22nm process incorporating tri-gate transistors popularly known as 3D transistors, which allows faster switching of states, and packing in more transistors.

The micro-architecture hasn't changed much from Sandy Bridge, you have the same 100 MHz base clock on

which most on-die components work.

We tested the Ivy Bridge processor on the Intel DZ77GA-70K motherboard along with 8 GB DDR3 RAM at 1600MHz

using Intel 520 series SSD. As expected the i7-3770K aced all the CPU intensive tests and gave scores that were 10 to 15 per cent more than that obtained on the Core i7-2600K. We overclocked it to 4.2GHz over air and got around 15 percent jump in the Cinbench score.

Intel HD4000 graphics gave very good frame rates in most of the games. Touching almost 30 FPS in *Dirt 3* at 1680x1050,



medium preset. *Resident Evil 5* at 1680x1050, med gave 40FPS. These scores were 10-15 FPS higher than those obtained with the HD 3000

But the AMD A8-3850's HD 6550D graphics still gave superior frame rates.

For Sandy Bridge users, it does not make much sense to upgrade to the i7-3770K. If you are looking purely at gaming prowess, then the A8-3850 crossfired with HD 6570 will give superior performance. But users who gave Sandy Bridge a miss, this processor makes for a great upgrade option.

Nimish Sawant

Specifications

Core Clock: 3.5GHz; **Cores / Threads:** 4/8; **Turbo Clock:** 3.9GHz; **L3 Cache:** 8 MB; **Graphics:** Intel HD 4000

Contact

Intel

Website: www.intel.com

Email: support@mailbox.intel.com

Price: ₹16,000

8.0/10

Features	8.0
Performance.....	8.5
Build Quality	NA
Value for Money	7.5

CM Choix PowerFort 5600 mAh

Ensures your gadgets never run out of juice

Specifications

Power Capacity: 5600 mAh;

USB Input: DC 5V/1A;

USB Output:

Type: Li-Ion

Weight: 132 gm

Recharge Time: 6-8 Hours

Contact

Cooler Master India

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Website: www.cooler-master.in

Price: ₹3,500

If you roll around with a multitude of electronic gadgets – a laptop, latest high-end smartphone, tablet, etc. – and always face the issue of batteries dying on you, then you need a rechargeable power pack like the CoolerMaster Choix PowerFort 5600 mAh. The thing is quite light and compact, 3 inches wide and weighing 132g. It's easy to stow away in your laptop bag or backpack.

The Choix PowerFort has a silver strip on its top with four LED indicators and a button – the indicators show how much charge is left, while the button is a toggle switch when you connect a gadget to the portable battery pack. The package



includes two wires to charge devices through a mini and micro-USB port, respectively – the Choix PowerFort itself charges through a micro-USB port. The Cooler Master PowerFort lets you charge a variety of PMPs, smartphones (Android, iPhone, Blackberry, etc.), tablets (Android, iOS, etc.) and Bluetooth headsets.

As for its performance, the Choix PowerFort performed pretty well. Charging it took around 8 hours – a bit too long, we think, but just as advertised by the manufacturer to be fair – and we successfully charged a Samsung Windows Phone, Blackberry and Android smartphone. This almost drained out the PowerFort, while a phone took between an hour and 90 minutes to charge. iPads and iPods charged successfully as well, no problems at all. We liked the PowerFort, it's a must-have device for someone with loads of gadgets on the move.

Jayesh Shinde

7.0/10

Features	7.5
Performance.....	7.0
Build quality	7.0
Value for money	6.5